Evidence of Teaching Effectiveness

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I have taught as a preceptor at Princeton since Fall 2023, leading my own weekly sections (precepts) in introductory macroeconomics and in a cross-listed undergraduate and graduate course on China's financial system. At the end of each term, the students in every precept section rate the overall quality of their precept. Below I compare the ratings of my sections with the average across all precept sections of the same course and term, and I quote what my students wrote.

6 of 10
of my precept sections were rated above the course average

+0.82
points above the course average in my strongest section

56%
of my students rated my precepts Excellent or Very Good

My record relative to the course average

Term	Course	Responses	My sections vs. all sections	
Spring 2026	ECO 101 Introduction to Macroeconomics	9	**Above average**	**+0.22**
Spring 2025	ECO 101 Introduction to Macroeconomics	24	**In line with average**	**−0.05**
Spring 2024	ECO 101 Introduction to Macroeconomics	11	**Above average**	**+0.46**
Fall 2023	ECO 101 Introduction to Macroeconomics	24	**In line with average**	**0.00**
Fall 2023	ECO 494 Chinese Financial and Monetary Systems	2	**Above average**	**+0.50**
Fall 2023	FIN 594 Chinese Financial and Monetary Systems	5	**Above average**	**+0.30**

Notes: each figure is the difference, in points on the 1 (Poor) to 5 (Excellent) scale, between the mean rating of my sections and the mean rating of all precept sections of the course in that term, as reported in Princeton's course evaluations. My strongest section (Spring 2024) was rated 0.82 points above its course average. ECO 101 was taught by Richard Rogerson in the spring terms and by Henry Shim in Fall 2023; ECO 494 (undergraduate) and FIN 594 (graduate) are the two listings of Wei Xiong's course. Seventy-five students rated my precepts in total.

What my students wrote

Clear explanations that deepen the lectures

- "Kevin really helped me learn macroeconomics! He was so helpful in office hours and made precept so easy to understand." (ECO 101, Spring 2025)
- "Kevin was a very helpful and engaging preceptor and he did a wonderful job explaining concepts, reviewing lecture content, and answering questions." (ECO 101, Spring 2024)
- "I really enjoyed the precepts and thought they were super helpful. They dug in deep into what the lectures were teaching." (ECO 101, Spring 2025)
- "I think that my classes with Kevin Cui were extremely helpful to my understanding of this course and its material." (ECO 101, Spring 2025)

Open to questions and easy to reach

- "The precepts were good. Kevin was always open to questions and he had an excellent grasp of the content." (ECO 101, Spring 2026)

- "There were many times that I was interested to learn more on a topic and then we would dive in deeper and examine many different examples. All students felt welcome to ask any questions as there was always a well constructed and informative response." (ECO 101, Fall 2023)
- "Kevin was extremely responsive to my questions and he was always available to clarify course material." (ECO 101, Spring 2025)
- "My preceptor did a great job at helping students through the material. He was usually clear and concise and always quick to respond to questions." (ECO 101, Spring 2026)
- "Precept was great, Kevin did a great job explaining everything and was always very reachable." (ECO 101, Spring 2025)

Prepared and supportive

- "Kevin was always very prepared and had slides. His review session before the final was very helpful, and he was always willing to answer questions in precept." (ECO 101, Fall 2023)
- "Kevin was supportive in assisting our learning and helped us try to understand the material completely if anyone was stuck. His precept slides helped a lot for me personally." (ECO 101, Fall 2023)
- "Kevin was a great preceptor—he helped clarify any questions I had on problem sets and his slides were useful for review." (ECO 101, Fall 2023)
- "I liked Rogerson and many of the preceptors, especially Chanisk Yoon and Kevin Cui." (ECO 101, Spring 2024, course-wide question)